USMCA reset possible as tariff deal edges closer

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【要点】

・トランプ大統領の関税脅迫によりUS-カナダ交渉が活発化し、8月19日の期限前に限定的な貿易協定成立の可能性が70%と見込まれている。

・カナダのカーニー首相は、報復措置の撤回と乳製品の限定的譲歩をUS製鋼・アルミ関税の削減と結びつける限定協定を受け入れ、より包括的なUSMCA交渉への足がかりにする姿勢を示している。

・米国は限定協定または交渉の実質的進展に対応して関税脅迫を撤回または期間延長する可能性があり、これによってより広範な二国間交渉への道が開ける見込みである。

・現在の交渉は、カナダの報復措置撤回と乳製品譲歩を、関税脅迫撤回と鋼・アルミ関税削減に結びつけることで、両国の対立を解決しようとしている。

・交渉が十分な進展を遂行できない場合、関税が予定通り発動され、その後の貿易協定交渉は遠い将来へ延期される可能性がある。

【メール原文】

Negotiations to prevent Section 338 tariffs have momentum. Trump’s 20 July threat to impose new 50% tariffs on $20 billion worth of Canadian goods und||||||||||||||

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Limited trade deal would unlock USMCA talks

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US President Donald Trump’s Section 338 tariff threat has unlocked US-Canada negotiations, with a limited trade deal now in view that would prevent their imposition before the 19 August deadline (70% probability).
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Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney is now likely prepared to accept a limited deal—linking the rollback of Ottawa’s retaliatory measures as well as marginal dairy concessions to reductions in US Section 232 tariffs on Canadian steel and aluminum—as a stepping stone to more comprehensive United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement (USMCA) and defense negotiations.
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Failure to make sufficient progress in ongoing talks would result in Section 338 tariffs being imposed on schedule, which would lead both sides to pull back and push any potential trade deal further into the future.

Negotiations to prevent Section 338 tariffs have momentum. Trump’s 20 July threat to impose new 50% tariffs on $20 billion worth of Canadian goods under Section 338 of the Tariff Act of 1930 has revived US-Canada trade talks (see note: Washington revives Section 338 to drive stalled USMCA talks with Canada , 21 July 2026). Trump and Carney subsequently agreed to “intensify” discussions, and United States Trade Representative Jamieson Greer and his Canadian counterpart, Dominic LeBlanc, will meet for the third time in as many weeks this week. Canadian officials hope to achieve sufficient progress to forestall Section 338 tariffs and now appear willing to accept a limited deal as a stepping stone to a more comprehensive agreement. For its part, the US could rescind the tariff threat or extend the 30-day window in response to a limited deal or at least substantive momentum in talks (70% odds).

A limited deal would unlock broader negotiations. The US has resisted initiating broad USMCA talks while Canadian retaliatory trade measures—including tit-for-tat automotive and steel and aluminum tariffs, as well as US alcohol bans at some provincially-owned liquor stores—remain in place. Canada, for its part, opposes limited talks that do not address US sectoral tariffs on Canadian goods. Ottawa is also wary of ad hoc concessions, since its digital services tax and online streaming rollbacks did not elicit reciprocal moves by Washington. Current negotiations reportedly seek to square the circle by linking the rollback of Canadian retaliatory measures, as well as marginal concessions on dairy market access, to the withdrawal of the Section 338 tariff threat and the reduction of US steel and aluminum tariffs.

A bilateral reset is possible. A deal to withdraw the Section 338 threat would open a pathway to address other contentious trade and security issues. Broader USMCA talks would tackle US automotive tariffs, rules of origin, and trade alignment vis a vis China (see note: Auto sector most exposed in prolonged North American trade shift , 30 June 2026 and Washington will constrain Ottawa’s reset with Beijing , 9 July 2026). Canada also aims to address the bilateral security and defense relationship with a focus on continental defense, Arctic security, and NORAD modernization, linking procurement decisions—for instance, its long-delayed F-35 acquisition—to progress on the trade front (see note: Deep US defense ties will limit procurement diversification , 15 December 2025). A limited trade deal could create momentum for a broader reset in bilateral relations.

Section 338 tariffs would severely limit space for near-term resolution. The collapse of talks—like in October, when negotiations over limited sectoral tariff relief for Canada broke down—and the imposition of Section 338 tariffs on 19 August would be an important signpost for Eurasia Group’s “Canada in the cold” scenario (20% probability), in which Mexico achieves a bilateral trade protocol with the US in 2026 but Canada does not (see note: Bilateral protocols are Trump’s Zombie USMCA endgame , 30 April 2026). For now, however, we continue to assess a bilateral US-Canada deal as likely this year, an outlook we would reconsider if Section 338 tariffs cut off negotiations heading into the fall.

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